

ometrya4paper, margin=1in
lheadFate's Edge
wtcolorboxnpcbox[1] colback=gray!5, colframe=gray!50, fonttitle=, title=1, boxrule=0.5pt
wtcolorboxpuzzlebox[1] colback=blue!5, colframe=blue!50, fonttitle=, title=1, boxrule=0.5pt
wtcolorboxcluebox[1] colback=green!5, colframe=green!50, fonttitle=, title=1, boxrule=0.5pt

LARGE The Guest Who Brought Death

Ubral: The Stone Between Spears

A Fate's Edge Adventure for Tiers III (3070 XP)

largeADVENTURE OVERVIEW

@ll **Region:** Ubral (The Stone Between Spears)

Tiers: 12 (3070 XP)

Themes: Honor, Law, The Price of Oaths, The Weight of GuestRight

Adventure Type: Investigation, Social Intrigue, Mystery with Magical Consequences

Estimated Play Time: 46 hours

Key Mechanics: Positioning, Story Beats, Social Conflict, Resource Management

largeTHE HOOK: BLOOD ON THE HEARTHSTONE

The feast of the First Snow is in full swing at HearthHall, a hillfort nestled in the high passes of Ubral. The hall is thick with smoke from the central fire, the air warm with the smell of roasting meat and the sound of clashing horns. Ten clans have gathered for the annual OathWedding between House Dorn and House Lorn, where their firstborns will swear a pact of blood and kinship.

The feasting has lasted three days when the host, High Chieftain Varrak the Stone-Tongued, calls for quiet. "By the hearthstone and the guestright, I welcome this man to my hall!" He gestures to a weathered traveler with a hooded cloak, who steps forward with a heavy wooden chest.

"Who brings you?" Varrak asks.

"None," the traveler says, his voice rough. "I am my own kin."

Varrak frowns but nods. "Then by the law of the stone, you are welcome here. Share bread and salt."

The traveler is given a seat at the high table. He does not speak much, but his eyes dart about the hall. On the third night, as the feast reaches its height, the traveler stands and raises his tankard. "To the clans of Ubral!" he cries.

The hall erupts in cheers. But as the tankard touches his lips, the traveler gags, clutches his throat, and falls dead. The tankard clatters to the floor, spilling a deep crimson liquid. The hall falls silent.

A woman screams: "He was poisoned!"

Varrak rises, face grim. "By the hearthstone and the guestright, the killer is as safe in this hall as the dead man. None may lay hands upon them, nor speak ill of them, until the cause is known."

The feast has become a prison. The killer is among them, and the clans are two days' ride from their homelands. If the law is broken, blood will flow.

Clue The ledger lists "oaths to be broken" names of clan elders who have broken sacred oaths. The map shows the location of the SoulSnare.

Scene 2: The Broken Oath (Puzzle Encounter)

The PCs discover the traveler was an OathBreaker a member of a secret society that punishes oathbreakers.

tem The traveler's body is found with a broken stone ring, the symbol of the Oath-Breakers tem The killer took one fragment of the ring

Reassemble the OathBreaker's Ring The ring must be reassembled to learn the traveler's purpose.

tem **Puzzle Mechanics:** Five fragments must be found throughout the hall and placed in the correct order based on the Oath of Stone and Spear:tem Stone (Stability) Fragment found near hearthstone tem Spear (Defense) Fragment found near weapons rack tem Hearth (Kin) Fragment found near wedding banners tem Sky (Oath) Fragment found near carved skygods tem Earth (Return) Fragment found near burial cairn window

tem **Solving reveals:** The traveler was an OathBreaker sent to enforce oaths tem **Failure:** Failing to solve within 2 hours results in 1 Story Beat and a false lead (e.g., House Lorn is the primary oathbreaker)

ACT II: THE BLOODPRICE RISES

Scene 3: The First Blood (Combat Encounter)

The next day, a blizzard traps everyone inside. The traveler's body vanishes, and a ritual is being performed outside.

tem **Antagonist:** Lira of House Dorn (a young woman driven mad by visions) tem **Guardian:** Wraith of Broken Oath (a shadowy figure that attacks with spectral blades) tem **Setting:** The burial cairn outside HearthHall, with glowing runes etched in the snow

Runes of the Cairn

tem The Wraith is immune to physical harm unless the runes are broken tem Stepping on a rune inflicts 1 Fatigue and makes you visible to the Wraith tem A successful Wits + Awareness roll (DV 2) allows a character to spot the faintly glowing rune before stepping on it tem Breaking a rune (Wits + Lore, DV 3) reveals one memory of the traveler tem The runes must be broken in the correct order (based on Ubral's oaths)

Clue One memory reveals the traveler was not an OathBreaker, but a WardReader sent to protect the OathWedding.

Scene 4: The Warden of Oaths (Magical Encounter)

The PCs find a journal that reveals the true purpose of the traveler.

The Journal of Oaths

tem **Puzzle:** The journal is protected by a Ward of OathKeeping tem **Mechanics:** One PC at a time may attempt to read (Wits + Spirit vs DV 3) tem **Consequences:** Each failure inflicts 1 Fatigue and reveals a halftruth. A character can attempt again after a brief rest (10 mins, 1 SB spent), reducing the Fatigue cost by 1 for that attempt.

Revealed Truth

tem The traveler was sent by a WardReader to protect the OathWedding from a SoulSnare tem The SoulSnare is a magical trap that would have bound the clans to eternal enmity tem The true traitor is still among them, and the SoulSnare is active

largeACT III: THE OATH THAT BINDS

Scene 5: The True Traitor (Social Climax)

The true traitor is Bran the StoneReader, who has been feeding false information to Lira. He believed the OathWedding was a trap by House Lorn. The SoulSnare is active and will spring at dawn.

Final Choice:

tem **Confront Bran directly:** Requires a successful social contest (Wits + Presence vs DV 3) tem **Let him expose himself:** Requires the PCs to steer events (e.g., convincing Lira to recount visions under oath, planting evidence, publically reading journal halftruths)

Scene 6: The Breaking of Oaths (Climactic Confrontation)

The true threat arrives the WardReader, a figure cloaked in shifting stone.

tem **Antagonist:** The WardReader (uses earth and stone magic) tem **Guardians:** Two OathBound Guardians (spectral figures that attack with the force of broken promises)

Climactic Choice:

tem **Let the SoulSnare consume someone:** The OathWedding is completed at great cost tem **Try to break the SoulSnare without sacrifice:** Risk of failure tem **Let the trap activate:** The clans are bound to eternal enmity

CONSEQUENCES

If the SoulSnare is Broken Without Sacrifice: The OathWedding is completed, but the cost is high one PC or NPC is cursed with "The Weight of Oaths" (1 Fatigue penalty for all social rolls for 1 week) The WardReader is banished, but swears revenge

If a Sacrifice is Made:

The OathWedding is completed The sacrificed person becomes a legend in Ubral The WardReader is banished The PCs gain the respect of the clans (1 level of Social Capital with Ubral)

If the SoulSnare is Not Broken:

The clans go to war The PCs are branded oathbreakers They are exiled from Ubral

GM GUIDANCE

Ubral Cultural Elements to Emphasize:

Guestright is sacred: even the killer is protected until the truth is known Every action has weight: oaths are binding, and breaking them has consequences The land remembers: broken oaths are remembered by the stones

Pacing Tips:

Let the social encounters build tension before the magical combat Verbally track time pressure: "45 minutes gone... the wind is picking up outside..." Make the SoulSnare a real threat have the PCs feel the timer ticking The final choice should feel momentous, with no "perfect" answer

Themes to Highlight:

The cost of law and order How traditions can both bind and protect The weight of choice in a world where oaths shape reality

ADVENTURE SEEDS FOR FUTURE SESSIONS

The Weight of Oaths: The PC who made the sacrifice returns as a Wraith of Broken Oath. **The WardReader's Revenge:** The exiled WardReader gathers forces to break the OathWedding. **The Unbroken Oath:** The clans demand the PCs mediate a dispute between warring clans.

largeGM NOTES

This adventure is a story about the weight of law and the cost of oaths. In Ubral, every word matters, every action echoes, and the land itself remembers. The adventure forces the PCs to confront the true price of the laws they live by and decide what they are willing to break to save a people who believe in laws that may be their ruin.

May your choices be as heavy as the stones of Ubral.